

Microcebus berthae

Madame Berthe's mouse lemur



Location W.C. Madagascar

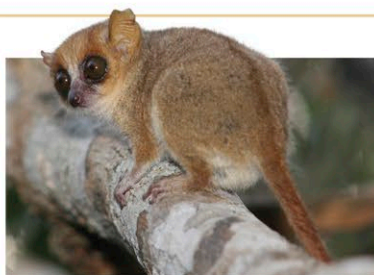
Length 3½–3¾ in
(9–9.5 cm)Tail 5–5½ in
(13–14 cm)Weight 1½ oz
(31 g)

Social unit Individual

Status Endangered



The world's smallest primate, this tiny reddish lemur is found only in the Menabe region of western Madagascar.



The species lives in dry deciduous forest, where solitary individuals have bigger home ranges than those of related species in the same area. Males roam much more widely than females and are very promiscuous. Although said to be abundant and adaptable, the total population—perhaps only 8,000 breeding animals—is confined to an area of just 347 square miles (900 square km).

Propithecus verreauxi

Verreaux's sifaka

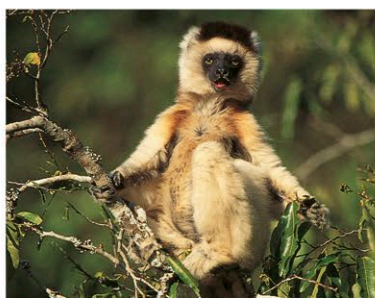
Location S.W.,
S. MadagascarLength 16–19 in
(40–48 cm)Tail 20–23½ in
(50–60 cm)Weight 6½ lb
(3 kg)

Social unit Group

Status Endangered



This large, mostly white lemur has brown-black areas on the face, crown, and undersides of the limbs. It uses its powerful legs to move among cactuslike trees with massive, spring-loaded leaps. It eats a wide range of leaves, fruit, flowers, and bark. Living in variable social groupings, it makes its "sifaka" call when two groups dispute territorial boundaries.

*Lepilemur betsileo*

Betsileo sportive lemur



Location C. Madagascar

Length 11 in (28 cm)

Tail 12¾ in
(33 cm)Weight 2¼–2¾ lb
(1–1.25 kg)

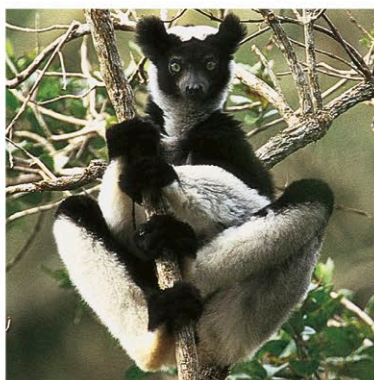
Social unit Individual

Status Endangered



The nocturnal tree-dwelling sportive lemurs are so-called because of their habit of leaping between vertical tree trunks using powerful hind limbs. On the ground they hop like kangaroos. Named after a Malagasy tribe, the Betsileo sportive lemur is one of more than a dozen species that have been recognized in recent years on the basis of genetic studies. It is grayish brown with a black tail and lives in rainforests of the Fandriana region of eastern Madagascar. Most sportive lemurs eat leaves, supplemented with flowers. They forage alone and defend territories with vocalizations and sometimes physical aggression, but at night small groups may sleep in the same tree hollow.

flowers, and seeds. Indris live in pairs with their offspring. The male defends their territory, and the female has first access to food. Indris are mainly black, with white patches.

*Indri indri*

Indri



Location E. Madagascar

Length 25–28 in
(64–72 cm)Tail 2 in
(5 cm)Weight 13–20 lb
(6–9 kg)

Social unit Pair

Status Critically endangered



Largest of the lemur group, the indri or babakoto ("little father") has very long rear legs, for enormous leaps, but a very short tail. Although diurnal, it is inactive for long periods in the day. The diet is chiefly young leaves, but also fruit,

Daubentonia madagascariensis

Aye-aye

Location N.W. and
E. MadagascarLength 12–14½ in
(30–37 cm)Tail 14½–16 in
(44–53 cm)Weight 5½ lb
(2.4–2.6 kg)

Social unit Variable

Status Endangered



The aye-aye has coarse, shaggy black fur with a mantle of white guard hairs. It is specialized as a nighttime primate "woodpecker." It taps trees with its long middle finger, listens intently with its huge ears for wood-boring grubs under the bark, exposes them by gnawing with its rodentlike, ever-growing front teeth, and extracts them with the middle finger. It also eats fruit, including coconut flesh, seeds, and fungi. Aye-ayes share large, stick-made nests but use them in succession, not together. The offspring stays with its mother for 2 years.



LONG FINGERS

The aye-aye uses its elongated middle finger, which has a double-jointed tip, to extract grubs from under tree bark.

Believed to be extinct until its rediscovery in 1957, the aye-aye is present in two dozen of Madagascar's national parks and nature reserves, and several small captive breeding colonies have been set up. However, with constant pressure on the island's natural resources, its future is likely to remain entirely conservation-dependent. Here, a one-day-old aye-aye is being weighed.

*Tarsius bancanus*

Western tarsier



Location S.E. Asia

Length 4½–5¼ in
(11.4–13.2 cm)Tail 8–12½ in
(20–23 cm)Weight 3½–5 oz
(110–140 g)

Social unit Individual

Status Critically endangered



This long-tailed, nocturnal Asian prosimian is small and compact-bodied. Mainly tree-dwelling, the western tarsier has slender fingers and its toes have pads and sharp claws, for gripping branches. It can turn its head to look backward and detect possible predators or prey with its huge eyes and keen ears. Its diet consists mainly of insects. Having spotted its victim, it creeps nearer and then leaps on it and seizes it with its front paws. The female

gives birth to one offspring after a gestation period of about 180 days. At first the young is carried by the mother, but it soon learns to cling to her fur.

